In the Blue Hours of Morning

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/64581364.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
and everyone else is briefly there, also featuring: Adora's Bright-Moon-themed knife, Light Angst, Mild Hurt/Comfort, British Humour, Accidental Stabbing, Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), in the flavour of:, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Canon Compliant, in all respects except for that, you can pry POTSie Catra from my cold dead hands

Language:
English

Series:
Part 2 of A Constellation of Moments: Theme and Variations

Stats:
Published: 2025-04-10 Words: 1,378 Chapters: 1/1

In the Blue Hours of Morning

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/64581364.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
and everyone else is briefly there, also featuring: Adora's Bright-Moon-themed knife, Light Angst, Mild Hurt/Comfort, British Humour, Accidental Stabbing, Adora Has Issues (She-Ra), in the flavour of:, Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder - PTSD, Canon Compliant, in all respects except for that, you can pry POTSie Catra from my cold dead hands

Language:
English

Series:
Part 2 of A Constellation of Moments: Theme and Variations

Stats:
Published: 2025-04-10 Words: 1,378 Chapters: 1/1

In the Blue Hours of Morning

by enby_lydia

Summary

Everybody who has been near a sleeping Adora knows that she sleep-fights.
Unfortunately, a knife is near a sleeping Adora.
Unfortunately also, Catra is now near a sleeping Adora.
You can guess what happens.
Oops.

(This fic is intended to work as a standalone, but for those acquainted with my other work ACOM, it would replace Feb 16, 1002)

The title is from Dear Wormwood by The Oh Hellos.

Content warnings: blood/injury, brief references to sex, strong language, violence

Notes

The paragraph spacing looks kind-of weird at first but I promise there are rules behind it and it makes a lot more sense to me as to distinguishing who is currently acting and speaking

Adora was sleeping in. When they'd noticed, the rest of the dorm had shrugged at Catra and headed off to the locker room. Bastards.

Not that Catra was thinking it, at all, ever – but – Adora was kind-of… cute… like that. Sleepy. Sniffling slightly – Catra knew that when she woke up, she'd have a stuffy nose and be grumbling all day, and that put a dampener on the cuteness. Which, as has been mentioned, wasn't there in the first place.

Catra sat there for another few seconds, and then started clapping loudly over Adora's face.

"Wake up, idiot! Get your butt over to a hairbrush! You look like a dead rat!"

Adora launched upright and shoved Catra off the bed.

"Uh, what? Huh?"

In retaliation, Catra tackled Adora onto the floor on the other side, and they ended up wrestling each other over to the dormitory door. The breakfast bell rung just as Catra got a hand over the line: she made a victorious face at Adora and scampered away on all fours.

Adora's bedroom has east-facing windows; the bedroom that Catra was offered for her first night in Bright Moon had north-west-facing windows. This discrepancy, she maintains, is the singular and only reason she crawled into Adora's bed at eleven o'clock last night, because it really wasn't fair that there's a bedroom perfectly situated for the morning sun, and that the only two cats in the entire palace weren't put up there.

Anyway, she's enjoying it now – the light streaming through the window is landing precisely across the bed (possibly, maybe, because Catra made Adora move the bed at half past eleven last night), and Catra smiles to herself and stretches, already purring. She shoves the duvet off herself and notices that Melog, lounging over on a rug in the middle of the room, seems to have had the same idea. Its mane and tail are tinting slightly gold where the light hits it.

After a while, Catra's feeling thoroughly warm, and thoroughly like death – because apparently Adora doesn't keep water by her bed? Is she insane? – and she decides to go and get herself a glass of water. This, unfortunately, necessitates *going* and *getting*, so she reluctantly sits up.

There's a flurry of movement next to her and then she's punched full-force in the stomach.

"ch – Ow. You're gonna have to quit the sleep-fighting, Adora."

Adora yawns and starts rubbing her eyes. Weird, is her face bleeding? Is that some kind of- ohhh, shit.

Catra looks down tentatively at where Adora punched her. Now she can see the knife-hilt sticking out of her, it does actually feel a lot more like a stabbing. Which it is. Ah. That's a problem.

"Why're you awake at, like, five in the AM?", Adora mumbles sleepily.

It takes some monumental effort not to start shouting at Adora for the fact that she *still fucking sleeps with a knife* – like – the war is over! And did she never learn basic safety? For the second time this morning, is she *insane*? – but there are more important matters at hand currently.

"Ow."

Catra's not feeling particularly eloquent.

Once Adora's blinked herself awake, she zeroes in on the issue with something approaching the necessary urgency.

"Oh, stars, Catra, crap, did I – uh – I didn't – oh, no, no no no-"

"Snap out of it and heal me."

Catra's doing her level best to ignore the way gravity is starting to spin. She's very good at it. She can handle herself like an adult.

Granted, an adult who is rapidly approaching the line between consciousness and whatever the opposite of that is. Or maybe there's a secret third option, and it's something to do with the

pain that's stopping Catra from breathing entirely properly. She's not really sure.

She-Ra flashes into being, conspicuously *without* her sword, flapping quite a bit.

"Right. Right yes I can do that I'm She-Ra haha uh um okay we're gonna be fine I'm fine you're fine um. Catra. I can't, uh. Heal. The knife. Is. Uh."

Catra rolls her eyes, grabs the (now rather slippery) knife-handle, and braces herself. She's done it before, and that was *fine*, she's pretty sure.

"Look away now, or don't, I don't care. Ten-nine-eight-seven-surpri- *ow, fuck* -se, bitch."

She hardly registers Melog's shocked yelp. Oooh. That's a lot of blood. Wow. That's not good.

She-Ra is cradling her, then, and that's better, and then there's the healing glow, and that's worse. Catra's fairly sure she's about to pass out.

"No, what I'm trying to say is, you *cannot sleep* with a *knife* under your *pillow*. Yes?"

Adora wipes her eyes on the blanket again and nods slowly.

"Should we, uh, get you checked out by a healer? I might've messed up your insides or something. I don't really know how the healing works. And, uh… sorry about the new scar."

"Nah, this one turned out kinda nice."

Completely shirtless at this point – still lying in the sun – and not seeming to care that windows work in two directions, Catra runs her fingers over the slight indentation of scar tissue just under her ribs on the right-hand side. In-between reassuring Adora, she's managed to clean it all up via the sole mechanism of licking her hand and wiping away the blood.

"Anyway, I'd be dead or something if my organs were fucked up. She-Ra's magic, anyway, so I'm pretty sure she's pathologically incapable of doing a bad job."

"Glimmer'll be mad about the bedsheets.", Adora mutters, mentally cataloguing how long the stain's been there. Long enough for Adora to have a full-on panic attack, at least. She's fidgeting with the knife now, passing it from hand to hand four times for every breath she takes.

"Glimmer can fuck off to recharge or whatever. Go put that somewhere safe."

Catra gestures lazily at the knife.

Sighing, Adora gets up and – holding it properly by the blade as she walks, because they don't need another stabbing this morning

– takes the knife over to her bookshelf. She initially puts it high up, but, after considering that that has all the potentiality of falling on people, moves it to a middle shelf, sandwiched between a couple of romance novels.

"She doesn't have to recharge anymore. Hasn't for ages."

"Do I care?", Catra shrugs.

Catra and Adora are late for breakfast. This would be alright, absolutely *fine* with Bow, actually, except that it's now up to him to field the rest of the Princess Alliance's concern. He's pretty sure that Mermista is correct (although who knew there were *that* many euphemisms for sex?), and he's vaguely trying to maintain his best friends' dignity whilst also trying to reasonably shoot down Frosta's idea that they're dead, Entrapta's hypothesis that they're in the Fright Zone, Sea Hawk's conviction that they're at sea, Casta's and Micah's worry over a proper sleep schedule, and, primarily, Glimmer's annoyance that Catra is a bad influence on Adora's punctuality.

Scorpia and Perfuma are being the least actively unhelpful people here: they're sitting over in the corner feeding each other strawberries, at least as far as they can what with Scorpia's pincers.

“I’m gonna kick her out of my palace.”, Glimmer grumbles. “Just Catra – we’ll keep Melog ‘cause it’s cute and all. Catra can fuck back off to the Crimson Waste.”

Bow pats Glimmer’s shoulder.

“I really appreciate the effort you put into the PA breakfast, babe. Catra and Adora are probably just, uh… busy.”

“How would a *horizontal* tango even work? That’s stupid!”, Frosta shouts.

“Catra and Adora late log. Minute nineteen. I am beginning to realise that, since I don’t know where Darla is, they are potentially not on Etheria!”

“Ooooooahhhh – when the treacherous ocean stole our heroes, their one objective was very clear! – ose. To get to the palace in time to break the fast: would this adventure be their last?”

Sorry, where did Sea Hawk get a violin from?

At that moment, the doors open with a bang, and Catra and Adora tumble through, shoving each other and laughing.

“Guess what happened?”, Catra giggles. “This fucking idiot stabbed me in her sleep!”

"She *what*?!", Scorpia yells, jumping to her feet, while Casta wearily remonstrates, "Language."

Bow decides that this whole affair is very much not his problem.

Works inspired by this one

Old Wounds… And Fresh Ones, Too by TheStarGayzingEtherianCollection (TheStarGayzingEtherian)

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!